Community House Website

Website Improvement Recommendations

Purpose

This document records what we noticed on the Community House website, why it could be improved, how we suggest improving it, and what we still need to ask Community House before making any decisions. These are suggestions to discuss, not final decisions.

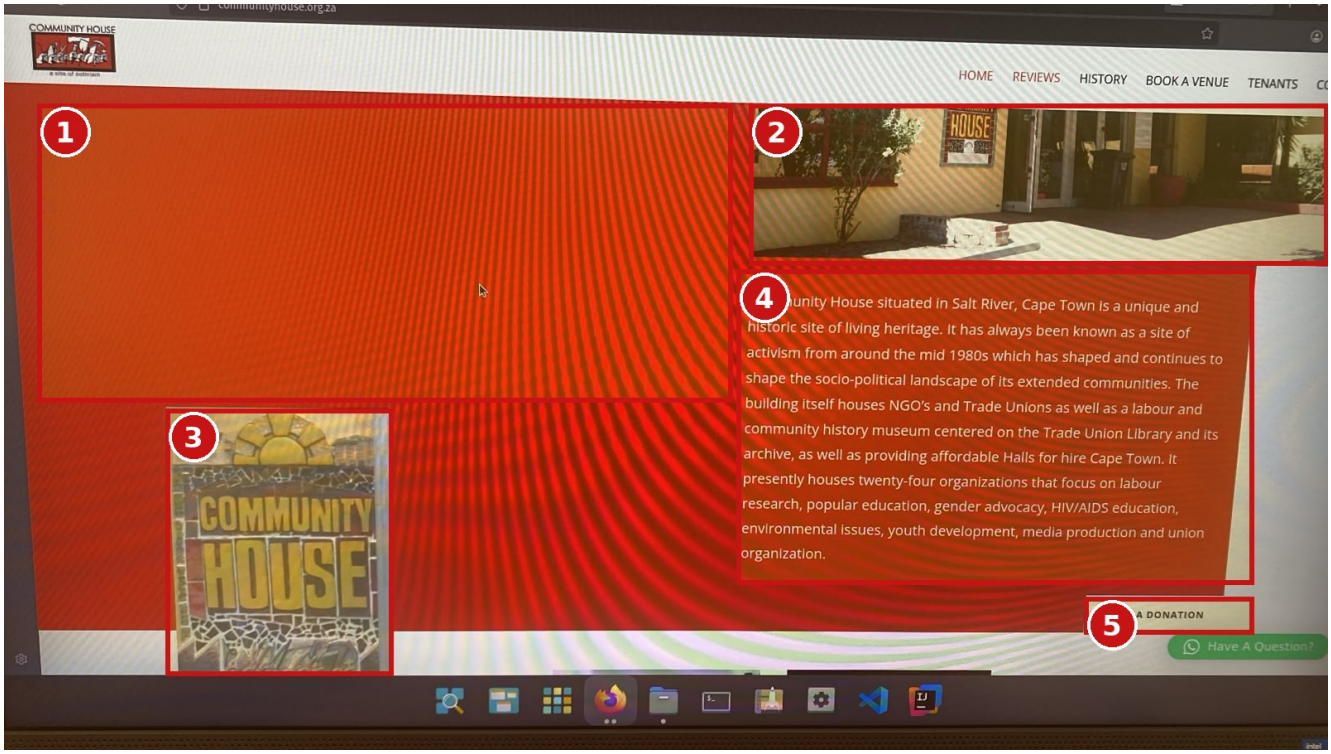
How to read the screenshots

Each screenshot has numbered red boxes. The number in each box matches the notes on the same page.

Summary of main findings

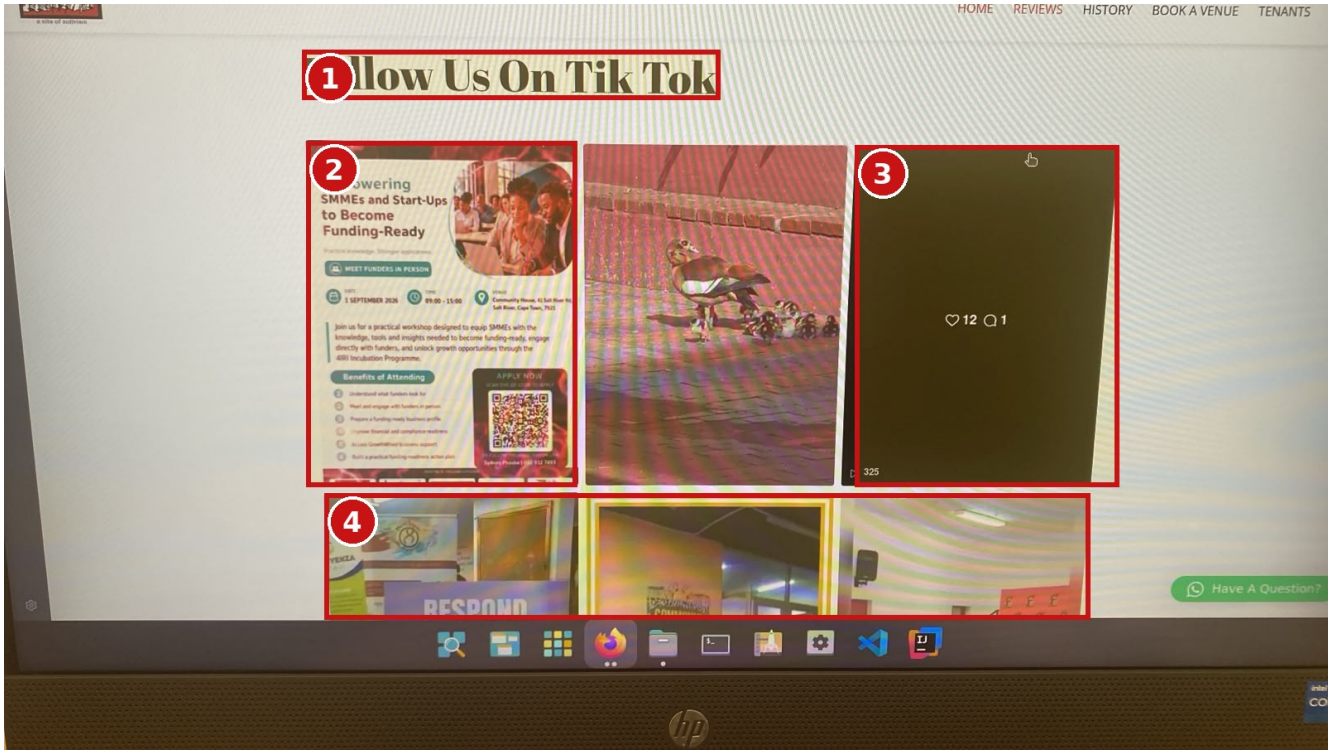
• The homepage does not explain clearly what Community House is, and the opening (About) section has layout problems and weak calls to action.
• The homepage is too long and repeats itself: donation and venue hire appear several times. Each topic should have one page and one menu item.
• Several things appear broken: the 'Call Us Today' button, the social media icons, and the gallery page (it shows code instead of photos).
• Photos are mostly from 2020, and the layouts and sizes are inconsistent. The TikTok section shows an old event and a tile that did not load.
• The Book a Venue page does not work properly: selecting a date on the booking calendar (even a whole day) does not let you book, and the page is not structured in a clear order.
• Text on the History and Services sections is small and low contrast. The contact form needs clearer labels and a clearer spam check.
• Strengths to keep: strong history and mission, a 4.4 Google rating (231 reviews), good hall photos, a working map and a WhatsApp 'Have a Question?' button.

Evidence 1: About section (homepage)



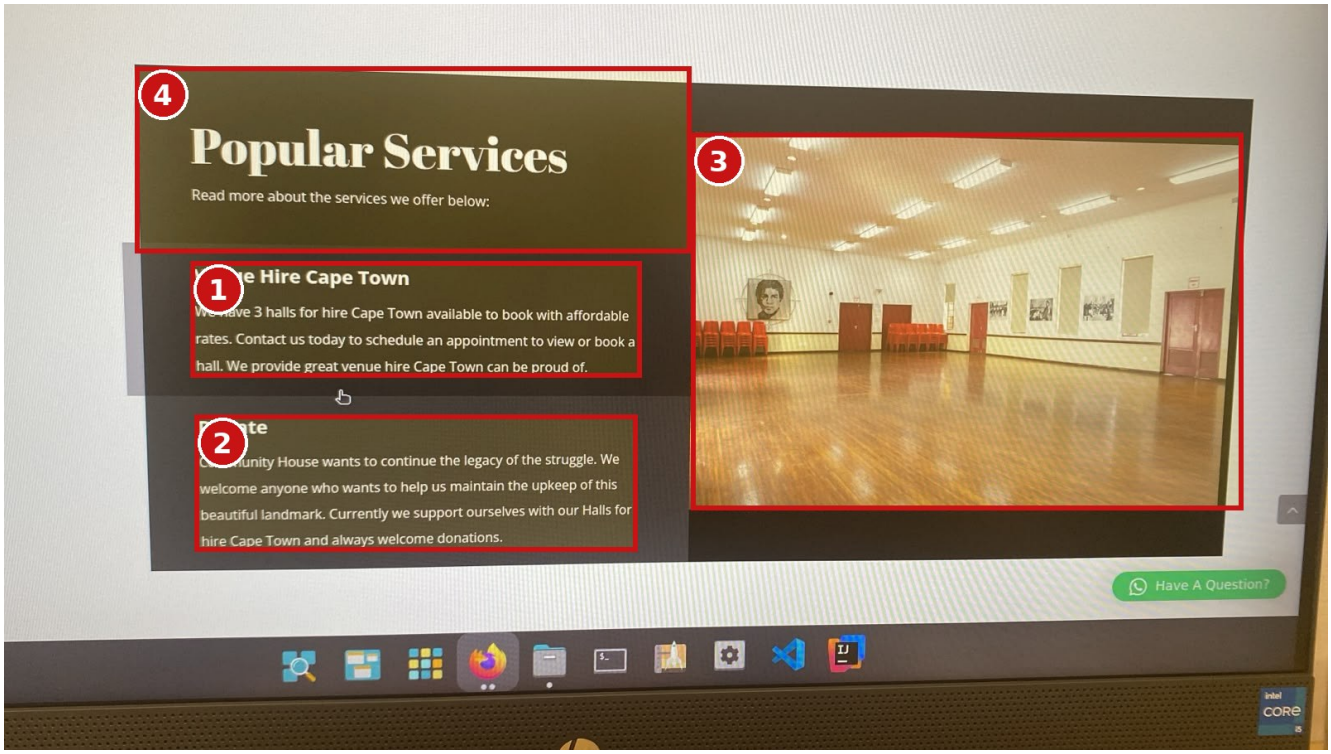
#	What we noticed	Recommendation
1	Large empty red area on the left; the content is pushed to the right.	Use the red as an overlay on a real photo of the building, with the About text on top, balanced and centred.
2	Entrance photo is cropped hard against the menu bar.	Crop so the full entrance and sign are visible, with consistent spacing.
3	Mosaic 'Community House' image is cut off at the bottom and not aligned with anything.	Align it with the text block and show the full image, or remove it.
4	About text is one long, dense paragraph. It does not draw the visitor in.	Shorten to 2-3 sentences: what it is, who is based there, what visitors can do. Add buttons (Book a Venue, Visit, Donate).
5	'Make a Donation' is a tiny tab at the corner and is easy to miss.	Make it a proper button that goes to one Donate page.

Evidence 2: Follow Us On TikTok (homepage)



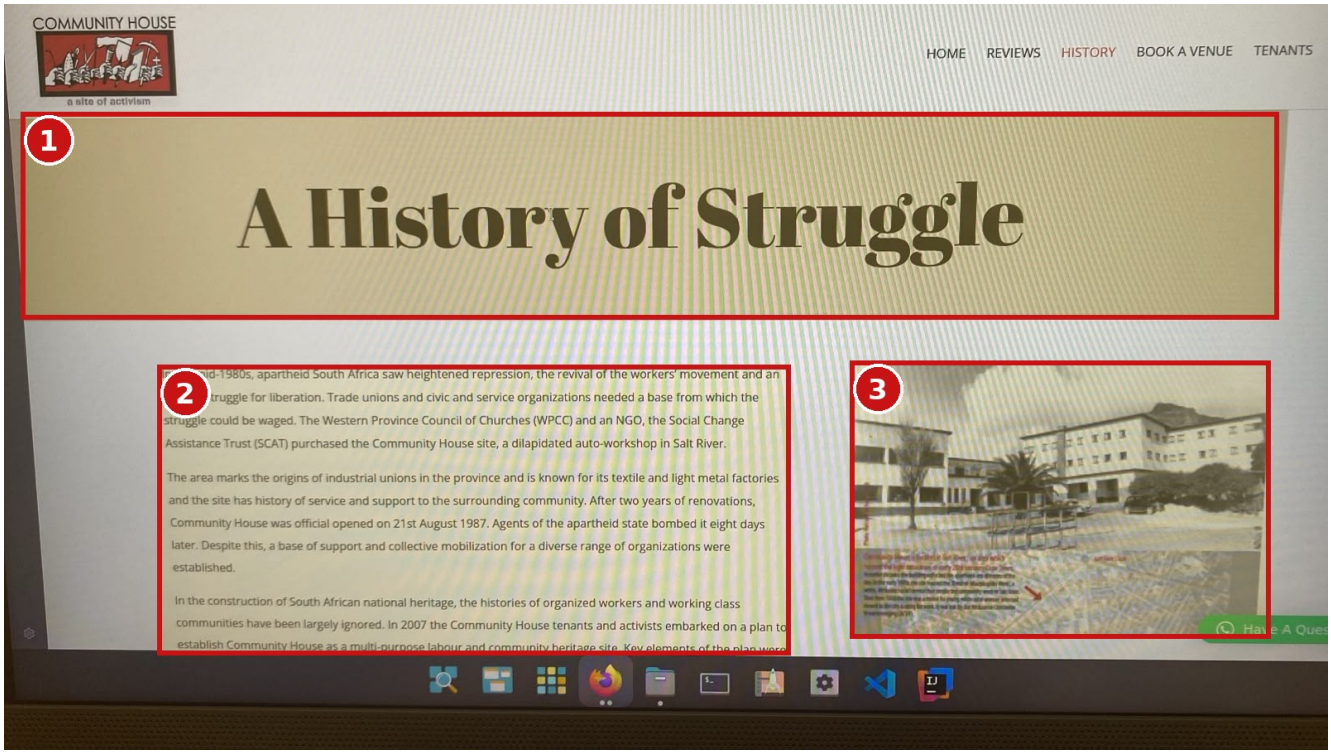
#	What we noticed	Recommendation
1	A whole section of the homepage is given to TikTok.	Replace with a small 'Follow us' strip and working icons for the active accounts.
2	Top post is a workshop flyer dated 1 September 2026, which has already passed.	Show only recent posts, and ask who manages the feed.
3	Black tile: the thumbnail did not load, only likes and views show.	Check the feed settings or plugin and fix it.
4	Tiles have different sizes and crops, so the grid looks uneven.	Use a uniform grid.

Evidence 3: Popular Services (homepage)



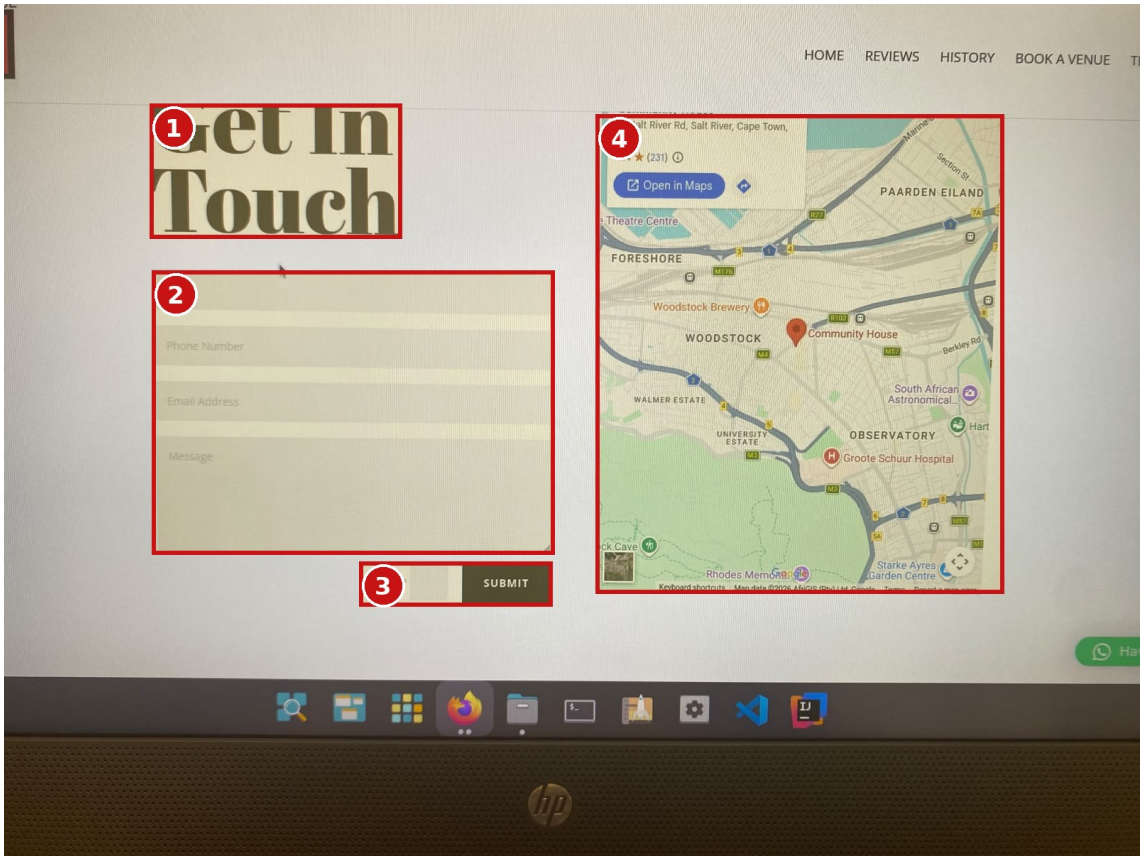
#	What we noticed	Recommendation
1	Venue Hire: 'Cape Town' is repeated three times in a short paragraph and there is no button.	Rewrite in plain language and add a 'Book a Venue' button.
2	Donate appears here again (it is also near the top and in Get Involved).	One Donate page, one menu item, remove the repeats.
3	Good quality photo of the hall. Worth keeping.	Use it on the Book a Venue page with photos of all three halls.
4	Small, light text on dark grey is hard to read.	Larger text and higher contrast.

Evidence 4: History page



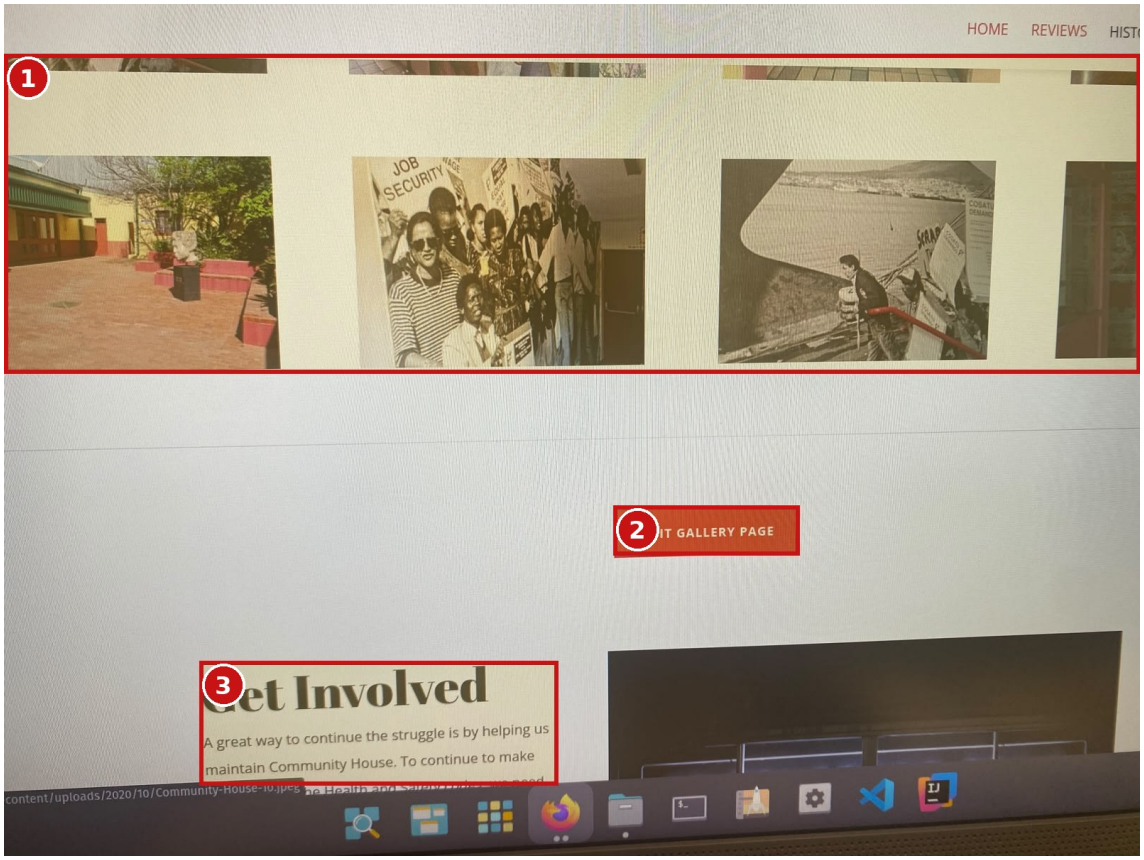
#	What we noticed	Recommendation
1	Very large heading banner takes up the top of the page.	Reduce it and use the space for an intro and photo.
2	Body text is small and light grey, and paragraph indents are uneven.	Larger, darker text with consistent spacing.
3	Archive photo has small printed text that cannot be read.	Use a larger version, and put the caption in normal text.

Evidence 5: Contact page



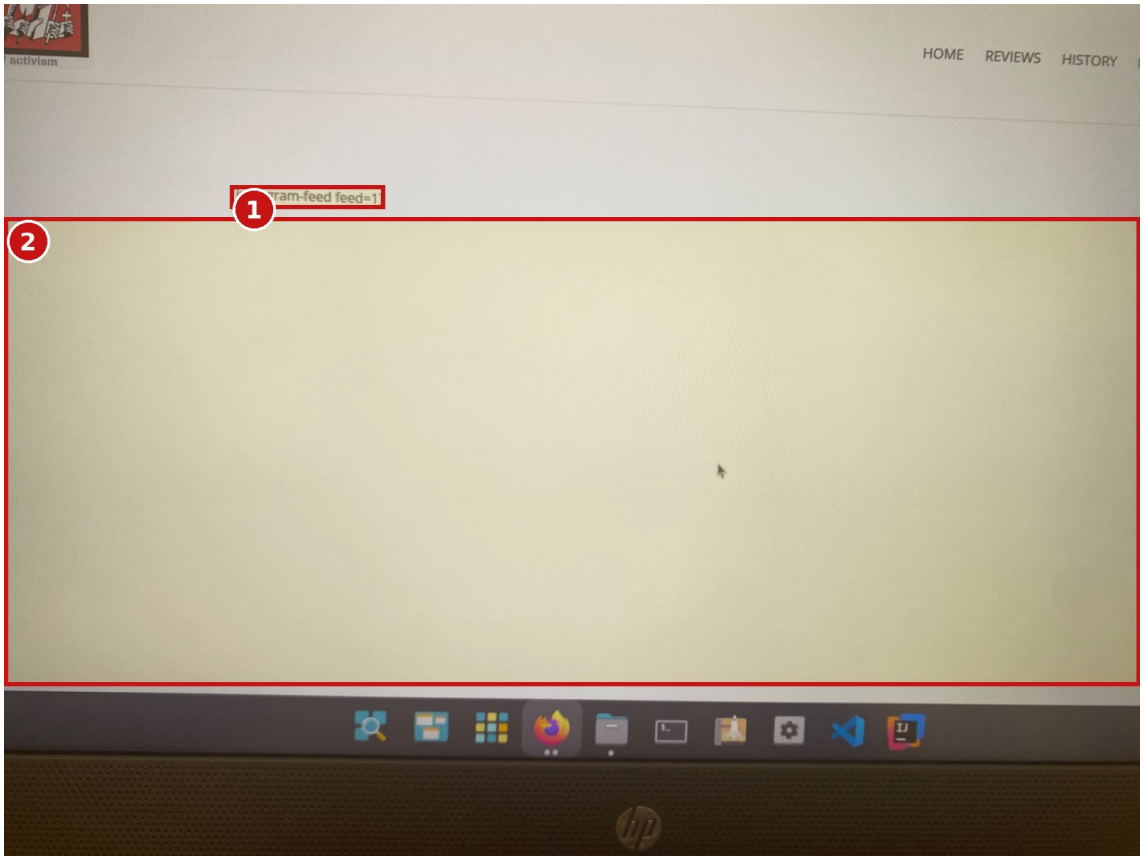
#	What we noticed	Recommendation
1	Heading wraps onto two lines and is very large.	Smaller heading, on one line.
2	Form fields have faint grey placeholders and no visible labels.	Add labels and darker text. Test that messages reach someone, and add a confirmation message.
3	'1 + 14 =' spam check is not explained.	Label it ('Quick check: what is 1 + 14?') or use a simpler spam filter.
4	The map works well and shows the 4.4 rating (231 reviews).	Keep it. Add the address, phone and hours next to it.

Evidence 6: Gallery strip and Get Involved (homepage)



#	What we noticed	Recommendation
1	Gallery photos are different heights and cropped at the top and edges.	Use a uniform grid with consistent crops.
2	'Visit Gallery Page' leads to the error shown on the next page.	Fix the link and the gallery page.
3	'Get Involved' is another donation message (third on the homepage).	Merge into the single Donate page.

Evidence 7: Gallery page error



#	What we noticed	Recommendation
1	Shows the code [instagram-feed feed=1] instead of photos. The Instagram feed plugin is not running or not connected.	Fix or reconnect the plugin, or replace it with a normal photo gallery. Ask who has admin access.
2	The rest of the page is empty: no heading, no intro, no photos.	Add a heading, a short intro and a fallback gallery.

Other observations (no screenshot yet)

Add a screenshot for each of these before the meeting.

Obs.	What we noticed	Recommendation
17	'Call Us Today' button does nothing when clicked.	Make it call the number on a phone and link to the Contact page on a computer. Test on both.
19	Homepage is overloaded: hero, donate, reviews, TikTok, services, gallery, get involved.	Keep the homepage short. Give each topic one page: Book a Venue, Donate/Get Involved, Gallery, Tenants, History, Contact.
03	Menu has Home, Reviews, History, Book A Venue, Tenants, Contact. No Gallery or Donate item.	Add Gallery and Donate. 'Reviews' only jumps to a section of the homepage, so consider removing it from the menu.
04	'Make a Donation' goes to an outside BackaBuddy page, but the 'Donate to Support' button goes to the Contact page.	One clear Donate page that explains what donations pay for, with working buttons.
05	Facebook, X and Instagram icons in the footer link to nothing.	Link to the real accounts or remove the ones not used.
08, 20	Reviews take a lot of space and several featured reviews are 2-9 years old.	Show the rating and 2-3 recent reviews in a small section, with a link to Google.
28	Book a Venue: the booking calendar does not work. Even after selecting a whole day, you cannot complete a booking.	Fix the calendar, or replace it with a simple enquiry form (date, hall, number of people, contact). Show a confirmation message after sending, and test on phone and computer.
29	Book a Venue: the page has the halls, the booking calendar, the equipment list, contact details and an 'About Us - Venue Hire' summary, but not in a clear order.	Structure it step by step: 1) the three halls with photos and capacities, 2) equipment and prices, 3) booking calendar or enquiry form, 4) contact details, 5) a short about/summary at the end.
06	Book a Venue: no prices shown, no photo of Elijah Loza Hall, and a typo ('cantered' instead of 'centred').	Add a rate sheet or price ranges, a photo for each hall, and proofread.
09	The page code blocks pinch-to-zoom on phones.	Allow zooming so people with low vision can enlarge text.
11	Staff emails are shown in plain text and opening hours are listed for 7 days.	Use role-based emails or a form, and confirm the hours are accurate.
27	Floating 'Have a Question?' WhatsApp button on every page.	Keep it, but check it does not cover text on phones and confirm who answers.
02	'Halls for hire Cape Town' is repeated many times.	Keep keywords in titles and headings, and use natural wording in the text.

Suggested homepage layout

1. Hero: photo of the building or people with a red overlay, a short About statement, and buttons for Book a Venue, Visit the Museum and Donate.

2. Who is here: a short strip showing the tenant organisations (link to the Tenants page).

3. Venue hire: three hall photos with a 'Book a Venue' button (details on its own page).

4. Reviews: rating plus 2-3 recent reviews.

5. Gallery preview: 6 consistent photos with a link to the Gallery page.

6. Social and footer: working social icons, address, hours, contact.

Questions for Community House (Thursday 5 Nov, 10:00-11:00)

1. Who is the main audience: venue hirers, museum visitors, donors, tenants or the media?
2. What are the top three goals: more bookings, more donations, more visitors?
3. Who controls the website, domain and hosting, and can we get editing access?
4. Which social media accounts are active and who runs them? Who set up the TikTok and Instagram feeds?
5. Can hall prices be published? Is the booking calendar and form working?
6. Where should 'Call Us Today' go, and who answers calls and the WhatsApp button?
7. Should donations go to BackaBuddy, and what do donations fund?
8. Who receives the contact form messages, and how quickly do they reply?
9. Is the tenant list current, and can we get logos and short descriptions?
10. Do they have newer photos, videos or museum and archive content, and permission to use them?
11. Is the museum or library open to visitors, and how do they book?
12. What can we change on our own, and what needs approval? What is the timeline?

Evidence checklist for ClickUp

[ ] Screenshots attached (cleaned, one per observation)
[ ] This document attached
[ ] Notes from the 5 November meeting added as a comment
[ ] Task status updated to Completed